



Sebastian

HIGH SCHOOL

Sebastian High School

Faulty Eva !

In Friendship era

By - Miss Unknown

Main Characters

Eva dandelion *

Sword Kinn*

Chenshi Denver

River Joseph*

Mickel Blacksmith

Side characters

Gord

Hammer

Shun

1.It might ever end

Gord didn't fight with **Eva** or say anything harsh. She simply grew silent. Messages became shorter, replies slower, and conversations slowly faded away. That silence hurt more than words ever could. Eva never imagined how one small decision of hers could affect their childhood bond. Somewhere deep inside, she sensed it would end soon.

The day came when she had to get enrolled in a new missionary school. Her mind felt like a rollercoaster. Everything turned out to be different from what she had imagined. As the pandemic continued, she quietly accepted the reality of leaving her old school behind, hoping the change would teach her something new and become a turning point in her life.

Maybe Gord had found new people in her life. They continued messaging for some time, and then one day, there was nothing left to say. No fights. No explanations. Just silence. Eva didn't feel shocked anymore. She was already tired of guessing what went wrong.

Her first-ever online lecture was French, attended on the Vevo app. That day became a confidence-grabbing moment for her. As she tried to join the class, a notification appeared: "Eva Dandelion trying to join the meet."

The French teacher allowed her to enter and suddenly asked her a question.

Fear rushed through her, but she answered.

Hush. She did.

The teacher smiled and placed her name on the leaderboard. Gradually, Eva began gaining recognition, and other teachers started noticing her talents. For the first time in a long while, she felt seen.

One fine day, she received a message on the live chat: “Will you please tell me which part is going on?”

That was when she noticed a guy named **Sword**. She had never heard that name before. She started noticing him in every meeting — sometimes he looked short, sometimes too sincere, and sometimes like a complete chatterbox.

On weekends, she had to go to school. As the day came closer, she felt no fear because she knew she had done nothing wrong. She became the topper of the class many times, scoring over 98 percent. Eva always studied well; she never imagined that she would want to be a top ranker. Once, she had even scored 99.99 percent in an open-book test in her previous school.

When the pandemic ended and school restarted, Eva was sitting on her bench when she saw Sword. Her heartbeat started racing. He was completely opposite to what she had imagined, yet sincere too. Before she entered the class, he was the one who surely topped it.

He came and sat at his desk and asked, “Eva, could you please pass me your French notebook?”

She handed him the notebook with a wide smile on her face. Their eyes met for a brief second before she looked away.

As days passed, she became his good friend — maybe only from her side. One day, while she was studying, he passed a chit that said, “Hey, I am going to tell you something tomorrow.”

The moment when the world paused for her.

Her heart spoke before her mind could stop it. Is this what I feel?

She couldn't sleep that night. Thoughts kept hammering her mind. She was a topper. She was sincere. She told herself to stop these unwanted thoughts, but they refused to leave.

The day woke her early, with a bright smile — unaware of what she was about to miss again: a true smile. She reached school and sat at her desk, waiting for him to come.

While looking at the window near her desk, Eva held her hands together and wished, “Please let the confession succeed.” She didn't understand what she was asking for, but the rush of emotions in her mind felt overwhelming.

She saw someone coming her way.

It was not Sword.

It was her classmate.

“Did Sword tell you something?” the girl asked. “Or ask you about someone?”

Eva couldn't process it properly and replied, “No... dear.”

After a pause, the girl said, “He needs your help to contact his girlfriend.”

She smiled weirdly and collapsed on her desk.

Eva couldn’t understand what had gone wrong. Everything felt ruined in a second. From that day on, she avoided his eyes. When he looked at her, she looked away. When he spoke, she stayed silent.

She didn’t talk to him for many days after that. A quiet heaviness followed her everywhere. For the first time, Eva had wished for something like this — and it disappeared in a single moment.

That was the day Eva learned that silence can hurt more than words ever could.

2.When Eva holds On

Eye contact and bond started collapsing and went on adding hurdles to come back to normal life for Eva. The world literally paused for her at that moment again. This time, not for something special coming her way, but as the beginning of something harsh on her path.

The feeling that could never get recognised was being felt in her heart every part of the day passing by. She named it “Love”, but it never completed itself for her.

The days passed on. Sword did not know what she felt, even before this happened. Maybe he had hints coming from her, but he never felt them. Eva was totally broken and started focusing on her studies again. This time too, she topped the class and ended up everything she felt for Sword.

Soon, she found a new talent growing in her potential — crafting. They had a bulletin board where they could display their artworks for the month. She actively participated in every competition and soon became an “All-Rounder” for everyone.

She got a new partner at that time, Chenshi. They met each other at a welcome meet in school.

“Are you Eva Dandelion?” Chenshi asked.

Eva smiled and answered, “Yeah, that’s me.”

Soon their friendship grew tall — daily calls, daily chats.

Soon they moved to the next class, Class 8. Eva didn't know what this year was going to test her for. Chenshi was a good friend of Sword, just like an elder sister. Eva was holding many things in her heart for a long time, and now she barely could hold anything in her mind. She decided to tell Chenshi everything she used to feel for Sword.

Eva began confessing everything she had on her mind — the unknown feelings she had been holding for many days.

“Chenshi, I want to tell you something important,” Eva said.

“Okay dear, please say,” Chenshi replied.

“Umm... I love Sword,” she said.

Chenshi started laughing.

Eva held both her hands together and asked in a low voice, “Why are you laughing?”

“Nothing dear, I understand you. But it's not love — what you are saying is a crush,” Chenshi explained. “Love should be a give-and-take feeling from both sides. You say you love him, but he already loves someone else, and that girl loves him too.

”

Eva shut up and rested her head on the desk. Chenshi could not understand her, Eva felt.

She raised her head and confessed, “I don’t want him to love me, but I didn’t like him because he is handsome or good-looking. He is a good human being by nature, and I can’t stop this messy feeling in my heart.”

“Will you help me?” Eva asked. “I just want to let him know what I feel for him.”

Chenshi agreed and said, “Okay, I will.”

(Chenshi also used to feel the same for him and then agreed to be like a sister towards him. Maybe she wanted Eva to do the same. The secret is still not told.)

It was break time. Eva went for hand wash. After coming back, Chenshi said she had confessed everything to him. But as she told before, he already loved someone else. The topic closed there.

Eva still loved him, but never told him by herself. She didn’t know what Chenshi really did. Was she really on Eva’s side, or did she say something that Sword would forever keep hurting Eva?

One day, Eva brought a tiny packet of cookies and presented it to him. She never wanted to confess her feelings and still didn’t want to let him go far. Fate always kept them together in the same class.

Sword kept teasing her, “Hey sis, please complete my work! Activity!” Chenshi also used to do the same. Soon, she started passing his work to Eva.

Eva, being mad in love, did everything he liked. She used to pray for him whenever someone asked her to make a wish.

The environment around her changed. Everyone felt something was happening. She could hear gossip — “Hey, do you know? I think Eva likes Sword.”

She was unaware of the fact that Sword was using her and making her do his own work.

One day, the English teacher, the head of the class, told that Sword was going to stand for Head Boy elections. Eva smiled, looking at him joyfully that day.

He asked Eva to help him make a speech for the elections.

Eva said, “Okay, give me your number. I will help you with the speech.”

Sword replied, “Sorry, but I can’t. I want to show it today itself, so please help me here in school, if possible.”

3.The loop continues

The feeling of not recovering was so intense that Eva could barely control herself. No matter how hard she tried, she couldn't stop Sword from being close to her. Destiny always seemed to create situations where he became protective towards her.

She already had feelings for him, but maybe he acted that way only because of his caring nature and the bond of friendship he believed in.

One day, when her friends teased Eva by taking his name, her face turned red, a soft blush spreading across her cheeks. Deep inside, she knew it was only a dream — something that could never come true.

Her body slowly began to heat up. When her friends touched her, they could feel the fever. Maybe it was because she was under intense pressure at that moment, unable to manage the emotions rising inside her

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Just then, Sword entered the classroom.
“Hey! What’s going on?” he asked.

The classmates explained everything that had been happening.

Suddenly, Eva saw a hand moving towards her forehead. She couldn't process it at first.

It was Sword.

He gently placed his hand on her forehead to check whether she was alright.

For a moment, they both stayed still, looking into each other's eyes longer than necessary.

Her friends started teasing her even more after that incident.

Maybe that simple, silent moment became one of the most beautiful memories of her life.

Eva could still sense his touch on her forehead. She felt deeply overwhelmed and joyful at the same time. She couldn't understand what exactly she was feeling, but the warmth stayed with her for long.

Sword won the Head Boy elections and was now going to represent the school. Eva felt genuinely happy seeing him become the chief. When the principal announced the results, Eva clapped harder than anyone else, cheering for him without hesitation.

August arrived, and the bulletin board work began. This time, it was Eva, Sword, Chenshi, and Hammer's turn to decorate it. They all went outside the classroom. Sword and Hammer were bad at decoration, so they used their strength to hold the board and its cover in place.

During this work, Eva and Sword came closer without realising it. Sword kept suggesting where to place the articles, while Eva found herself looking at him more than the board. She felt like she was on the seventh cloud. Her face turned red again.

Chenshi and Hammer stayed busy with the decoration. Soon, the bulletin board work was completed.

“Eva will be the new class monitor,” the class teacher announced.

Eva smiled. She had always liked being a leader. When she accepted responsibility, she followed it seriously. She already had principles in her mind. One of them was clear — anyone talking unnecessarily would have their name written on the board and be reported to the teacher.

One day, Sword was talking to someone during class. Eva wrote his name on the board.

“Eva, please give me one last chance,” he said.

“No,” she replied firmly.

He gently grasped her hand and said, “Please,” his eyes shining brightly.

She melted in a second and quietly erased his name from the board.

Suddenly, Eva heard a voice behind her. “What a C*****!”

She turned around immediately, furious, to find out who had said that. It was one of Sword’s classmates. Eva, being innocent, didn’t understand what the word meant.

In anger and confusion, she shouted, “Okay, yeah, I am a C*****!”

Eva didn’t realise what she had just said. She didn’t know it was a curse word.

Sword held her hand again and asked softly, “Do you even know what it means?”

She replied in a low voice, “No...”

“Go and search it,” Sword said. “Then you’ll understand what you just shouted in class.”

After searching, Eva realised the meaning of the word. She felt filled with regret and embarrassment. Yet somewhere deep inside, she felt a strange joy too — Sword had stopped her twice.

Everyone asked Sword to give a party for becoming Head Boy. He gave everyone five-rupee coins. Eva received one too. She collected many such coins and kept them together as memories. She never wanted to spend them.

On Friendship Day, Eva wanted to tie a band on his wrist. She kept waiting for him to come, standing with the band in her hand.

But he never came.

He had responsibilities now — responsibilities towards the school. The bell rang, and still, Eva couldn’t see him.

She accepted the situation silently and went back home.

The next day at school, one of her friends asked her to give a friendship band to Sword. Her friend felt shy doing it herself, so she chose Eva to hand it over.

She saw Sword standing in the middle of the boys' and girls' line. Eva held the band and showed it towards him. "This is your friendship band. Please take it," she said softly.

Sword replied angrily, "Friendship Day is over."

The words hurt more than she expected.

Eva felt hurt, but she didn't show it. It wasn't even her band — it belonged to someone else that she was only trying to give him.

Still, the day felt heavy and difficult for her to accept.

4. Being Happy

The day passed, and Eva returned home. She jumped onto her bed, feeling hurt by everything that had happened throughout the day—not because Sword had spoken harshly to her, but because he had misunderstood her.

From that day onwards, she decided not to take him too seriously. She stopped following everything he said blindly, especially when it caused her pain.

The next day, when the school bell rang, everyone attended their first class. The following lecture was declared off, and a substitute teacher sat quietly on the chair, busy with her own work.

Sword noticed something was wrong with Eva. He called her towards the desk in front of him.

“Are you angry with me?” he asked.

Eva replied gently, “No... why would I be?”

“Because I refused to take the friendship band,” Sword said. “You were giving it to me in front of everyone, and I couldn’t accept it. I’m sorry.”

Eva said calmly, “It wasn’t mine.”

He looked confused. “Then whose was it? And why did you bring it?” She pointed her finger towards Shun.

Sword understood.

In a low voice, Eva said, “Because Shun felt shy giving it to you. So I agreed to deliver it for him. It was my mistake—I thought you would accept it.”

Sword smiled slightly. “Don’t do this again.”

They enjoyed their tiffin together with the group. Slowly, they became good friends—maybe unknowingly close to best friends. They never called each other besties.

One day, Chenshi challenged Eva to push him by the shoulder. The reason behind the challenge was old and barely remembered.

It was interval time. Eva saw Sword walking towards her. Without thinking much, she walked in the opposite direction and pushed him. “Ouch!” Sword cried.

Everyone gathered around him at once.

“What happened, Sword?”

“Are you okay?”

Eva immediately regretted it. What have I done? she thought.

She ran towards him and said, “Sorry, sorry... please forgive me. I didn’t mean to hurt you.”

“Eva, why did you do that?” Sword asked.

She explained the challenge with Chenshi and quietly returned to her desk.

The situation was funny to hear, yet difficult to accept.

Gradually, as days passed, Eva began accepting Sword as a brother. She was a girl who never truly understood her own feelings—whether she liked someone in a way that wasn't right for her, or if she was simply shaped by the kind of relationships society expected her to have.

After the very first incident of that wrong confrontation, she slipped into a deep emotional sleep. These days, she didn't even realise how she behaved around him.

Soon, Sword started taking advantage of her good behaviour—perhaps for his own selfish reasons. Eva might have sensed it, but she acted as if nothing was happening. She didn't want to lose him, neither as a friend nor as a brother.

Slowly, Eva began to mature, especially after noticing how Chenshi and Sword intentionally used her for completing their academic work.

(The remaining incidents are related to their annoying behaviour and Eva's slowly fading feelings for Sword. In the upcoming parts, Sword behaves strangely, just to ensure Eva never returns to her past.)

5. Something new on Her way

One fine morning, when everyone was busy praying in the school assembly, Eva noticed a boy wearing a dark green shirt. She couldn't see his face, yet she felt something unusual—something she had never felt before. Without thinking much, she stepped into her classroom and continued with her lectures, unaware that the moment had already stayed with her.

After the fourth period, the bell rang for break. Students poured out of their classrooms, filling the corridors with noise. Once again, Eva saw the same boy pass by her side. He might not have noticed her, but she remembered him clearly—her first meeting with someone she hadn't truly met.

Soon, an announcement was made: there would be a patriotic group singing competition in the school. Eva's class practiced hard, but unfortunately, their class teacher couldn't attend school that day.

Eva, along with her friend Chenshi, took responsibility and led the group. However, things didn't go as planned. Eva couldn't sing that day due to a throat infection. On top of that, she was holding the flag, and it accidentally folded the wrong way during the performance. Nothing worked out. They failed and lost the competition.

Eva trusted herself less than she trusted anyone else. She was deeply hurt by her own actions.

I shouldn't have taken part in the competition. I'm good for nothing, she cried silently.

Her friends tried to console her, but their words couldn't drown out the whispers she heard nearby.

“She's mad.”

“She doesn't even know how to hold a flag.”

“She didn't sing either.”

Each word pierced her heart, leaving her standing there—quiet, broken, and questioning herself once again.

She didn't eat her tiffin and refused to talk to anyone.

When school hours ended and everyone began leaving for home, her sad face had to face one more difficulty that day. The van she usually travelled in got stuck somewhere, and her uncle couldn't come on time.

After making arrangements, her uncle asked her to sit in another van. It belonged to her nursery best friend, Richa. As the van moved, Eva shared everything that had happened that day. In the middle of the conversation, her eyes suddenly paused on someone.

It was the same boy she had seen earlier—the one in the dark green shirt. She couldn't understand why. Why only him?

Days passed. Eva remained deeply heartbroken. She refused to participate in any competition or school programme, slowly pulling herself away from everything she once enjoyed.

After the daily prayer one morning, the school principal announced that from the next day, Class 8 would begin Patroness Day practice.

Everyone got busy preparing. Eva sat with a few friends she knew well. That was when she noticed someone from her old school—Anver. It was an unexpected meeting. They spoke for a while, smiling and revisiting memories of their childhood friendship.

Suddenly, the teacher arrived and asked everyone to participate in the skit for Patroness Day. Eva refused at first, but the teacher forcibly added her name. She removed her spectacles and walked towards the practice area.

She was grouped with two unfamiliar boys. As she looked around, her eyes met the same sight again—the boy in the green shirt standing there.

Eva was assigned the role of a child, along with one of the boys, while the boy in the green shirt was chosen to play the role of Uncle Francis. The practice began, and slowly, Eva found herself talking freely with them.

Soon, rehearsals shifted to the auditorium. They practised, laughed, and enjoyed performing the skit together. For the first time in many days, Eva felt lighter.

In those moments, she forgot everything else—every hurt, every doubt, every pain she had been carrying inside.

6.The unfelt closeness

(A Flashback She Realised One Day)

Much later in life, Eva realised that this chapter had always lived inside her as a memory.

Not a clear one—but a faded, half-forgotten flashback she never knew she was carrying.

During the Patroness Day practice, the bond grew unexpectedly.

Every day they sat together during rehearsals—sharing space, lines, laughter, and silence. They played during breaks, joked between practices, and passed time without noticing how closely time itself was moving. Those days became the moments when Eva smiled the most, laughed the easiest, and felt strangely at ease.

She didn't feel discomfort sitting close to him.

The boy in the dark green shirt.

River.

Without realising when or how, River became a good friend to her.

One afternoon, during practice break, the group sat in a circle playing Truth and Dare, spinning a bottle on the auditorium floor. Laughter echoed as the bottle turned, slowed, and finally stopped—pointing at River.

Truth.

Someone asked, “Who’s your crush?”

Eva froze for a moment.

By then, she knew what the word crush meant—or at least what she believed it meant. Fake love, she thought. A temporary obsession. Something people exaggerated for fun.

River smiled lightly and answered,

“No one.”

Eva laughed a little and said casually,

“Haa... why would you tell us anyway? Fine, let’s continue.”

The game went on for a long time. Voices overlapped, laughter grew louder, and the bottle kept spinning.

Then, suddenly, something shifted.

River looked at Eva and asked, almost out of nowhere,

“Do you know about Sword... about his life?”

Eva stiffened.

She didn’t like that question. Not at all.

She disliked talking about his lifeline—his personal world, his relationships, his struggles. Every time that topic came up, something struck her mind sharply, pulling her out of the moment, making her feel distant from everything around her.

She didn't understand why.

Still, she answered softly,
“Yeah.”

Without another word, Eva stood up and left the place silently.

The laughter continued behind her, the game moving on as if nothing had happened.

But that silence stayed with her—longer than the question itself.

After that day, Eva stopped talking to him freely. She avoided long conversations, replied briefly, and slowly built distance without meaning to. Something had changed—but she couldn't name it.

Now, when she looked back, the incidents felt unclear. She didn't remember exactly what River meant by “Sword,” or what he himself was going through during those days. Time had erased the details, leaving behind only a feeling—heavy, unresolved.

Then Patroness Day arrived.

The school buzzed with excitement. Students waited anxiously for their turns, costumes rustling, voices echoing backstage. Eva's skit went well, and once it ended, relief washed over her.

Classes resumed briefly. Afterward, Eva and her friends clicked pictures together, laughing and capturing the moment. Even after the final bell rang and students left for home, Eva, Chenshi, and two other girls stayed back, clicking a few more pictures.

Suddenly, Chenshi shouted,
“Hey, River! Come here—let’s click pictures!”

Eva turned sharply toward her.
“Are you mad? Why are you calling him?” she whispered angrily.

Chenshi ignored her.

River walked over, and pictures were clicked. Eva stepped aside, refusing to join. Maybe she was hurt—by that unexpected conversation earlier, or by something deeper she couldn’t understand herself.

Days passed.

One night, Eva’s phone rang.

It was Chenshi.

“Hey... I need your help,” Chenshi said softly, her voice unusually low.
Eva frowned slightly.

“What happened now?” she asked firmly.

There was a pause.
“I think... I like someone,” Chenshi said.

Eva sat up.
“Are you mad?!”

But Chenshi continued, telling her everything—about her exam seating, her senior bench-partner, the back bench, the small conversations, the excitement she felt.

Eva listened, bored and distant.

These love stories tired her. Crushes, seniors, feelings—it all felt unnecessary, exaggerated, unreal.

“I’m not interested in your story,” Eva said coldly.

“Good night.”

She ended the call.

Lying in the darkness, Eva stared at the ceiling, her heart heavier than before—still unaware of how close she had once been to something she never allowed herself to feel.

Unfelt. Unnamed. Unfinished.

7.The Invisible Eva

Sword had been busy those days.

Being the Head Boy of the school came with responsibilities—announcements, discipline, meetings, expectations. He was everywhere, yet somehow never free.

Eva wasn't as close to him anymore.

Some days, they spoke normally.

Some days, two or three passed without even a glance between them. Not because of anger—just a distance that neither of them knew how to cross.

One afternoon, as they walked past each other in the corridor—Eva moving in one direction, Sword in the opposite—she whispered, barely audible,
“Invisible...”

Sword stopped.

He turned around and looked at her, a half-smile forming on his face.

“Oh—only you? Not me?” he replied softly.

Eva looked up, surprised.

Both smiled—small, quiet smiles—and walked back to their places as if nothing had happened.

But it wasn't nothing.

It was something unspoken between them.

That distance had begun the day Eva refused to do one of his works. She herself didn't know why she had done it. Eva was unclear with her own emotions—sometimes gentle, sometimes harsh, without understanding the reason.

After that day, a strange word followed them.

Invisible...

Invisible...

Never spoken loudly.

Just exchanged through looks and moments.

Days later, during the morning assembly, the Head Girl announced, "There will be a Best Out of Waste competition tomorrow."

Eva felt a small flicker of excitement.

She decided to make something simple—a birdhouse made of cardboard, with tiny fake bird eggs placed carefully inside. Nothing extraordinary. Just something neat and honest.

The next day, the classroom buzzed with activity. Scissors clicked, papers rustled, glue spread everywhere. Everyone was busy creating something they hoped would be noticed.

Eva worked quietly.

Then someone stopped near her desk.

“Hey, is it your nest?” the boy laughed and asked.

Eva looked up at him—for the first time.

She ignored him and continued her work.

From behind, someone called,
“Hey Eva, please pass me the glue.”

As she handed it over, the boy stared at her again.

“Are you Eva? I mean... Eva Dandelion?”

“Yeah,” she replied.

“Ohhh,” he said. “I’ve heard your name, but never saw you before.”

“Okay,” Eva said plainly.

He left, and she continued working.

What Eva didn’t know was that he was a good friend of River—and River had already told him something unexpected about her. Eva remained unaware of this.

She didn’t understand what was really going on.

Eva never mixed her personal life with her studies. She continued scoring good marks. But these days, she felt heavy.

Shun was improving rapidly in studies.

For the first time, Eva slipped to second position.

This year... something disgusting is happening with me, she cried silently in her heart.

That year, she was preparing for her Elementary Drawing Exam. Unfortunately, the boy she met that day was also an aspirant.

They didn't talk again.

Yet Eva felt tired—of such moments, of unexpected experiences she never asked for. This was the third time she felt something strange and unexplainable.

Days passed.

Chenshi had to take part in an extempore competition. At the same time, Eva and Chenshi were working together on the bulletin board. Eva wanted Chenshi to stay with her.

But that boy took Chenshi away for auditions.

Eva felt hurt—and angry.

She asked him to let Chenshi come with her for just five minutes, but he didn't allow it. His rude behaviour made her furious.

Soon, Eva had to talk to him again, because Chenshi needed to work with him.

Days continued to pass.

They kept meeting.

They kept talking.

And Eva—

still felt invisible.

8. Love or obsession

With Chenshi and Mickel around, Eva and River slowly began talking again. Without realising it, the four of them formed a small circle.

Gradually, they divided themselves into two pairs.

Eva with River.

Chenshi with Mickel.

After school, they often stayed back—talking, laughing, sharing moments that seemed ordinary at first. Days passed, and unknowingly, they became good friends.

Eva even forgot about the conversation with River that had once hurt her deeply. Maybe time had softened the pain, or maybe she was simply tired of holding onto it.

Soon, Shun also joined them.

Through competitions, group work, and shared responsibilities, she became a part of their circle. Eva pretended it didn't affect her, but she noticed changes she couldn't ignore.

Mickel started talking to Shun more.

Laughing more.

And slowly—ignoring her.

It hurt.

Eva had been the first to befriend Mickel. And now, someone else had taken her place so easily. Without saying anything, she began pulling away.

She stopped talking to River.

She stopped talking to Mickel.

For her, that friendship was over—even if no one else realised it.

Meanwhile, Chenshi was busy with her own boyfriend. During those days, she needed help, but when Eva refused—emotionally drained and exhausted—Chenshi turned to Elle instead.

Elle had always been close to Eva.

But soon, everything changed.

Eva began seeing Elle everywhere she once stood.

Her place had been replaced.

Eva stayed silent.

That silence grew heavy, and misunderstandings followed. Arguments broke out between Eva and Chenshi—sharp, emotional, and unresolved.

Then one day, Chenshi said something Eva never expected.

“I don’t trust you anymore,” she said coldly.

“I think one day you’ll beat me during a fight.”

The words struck harder than any slap.

Eva stood still—
not angry,
not loud,
just broken.

She had lost friends before.
But this time, she lost trust.

That day, Eva made a quiet decision—
There was no such thing as a best friend for her in this world.

Soon after, the results of the Elementary Drawing Exam were announced.
Mickel stood in front of the classroom, holding a stack of certificates. He
had been asked to distribute everyone's results.

As he handed them out one by one, he paused when he reached Eva.

Looking at her certificate, he smiled and said,

“Hey, Eva... see, you got a C grade.”

Eva looked at him with widened eyes, then turned her face away, ignoring
his smile.

She asked quietly,
“What about you?”

“I also got a C grade,” he replied. “Just like you.”

After a short pause, he asked,
“By the way... why aren’t you talking to me and River?”

Eva didn’t answer.

Her face hardened with anger. As she looked at him, his hands loosened, and a few certificates slipped from his grip, sliding across the floor.

Eva didn’t look back.

After that, she buried herself in her studies—refusing to notice anything or anyone around her. She convinced herself that distractions were dangerous and emotions were unnecessary.

That evening, during dinner, her phone rang.
It was Chenshi.

Eva hesitated, then picked up the call.

“Come online,” Chenshi said. “I want to show you something on video call.”

Eva joined.

On the screen, Chenshi held up a letter.

“A proposal letter,” she said softly. “From River.”

Eva froze.

“I don’t understand,” Eva whispered.

“I’ll explain everything tomorrow,” Chenshi replied.

The call ended.

The next day, Eva saw the letter with her own eyes.

She read it slowly.

Once.

Twice.

Then she stopped.

She felt angry—but more than that, she felt silent. A silence so heavy that even her thoughts refused to speak.

She wanted to ask River about the letter.

She didn’t know why she wanted answers.

She didn’t know what she expected to hear.

All she knew was that it felt unfair.

Why was God punishing her like this?

For what mistake?

Eva took one of her friends with her and decided to talk to River.

It was the last day before the second semester began. Holidays were about to start, and the campus felt unusually quiet.

Eva walked up to him, holding the letter tightly. She showed it to him and asked,

“Did you write this letter?”

Before he could answer, the French teacher arrived unexpectedly.

“What is that?” the teacher demanded.

He ordered Eva to hand over the letter. Eva tried to explain, but before she could finish, he shouted,

“Eva, give it to me!”

Her hands trembled. In a sudden rush of fear and frustration, she tore the letter into pieces and let some of them fall to the ground.

“I said give it to me,” the teacher warned. “Or I will take you to the principal.”

Left with no choice, Eva handed over the torn paper.

Without a word, both Eva and River walked away in opposite directions.

Silence followed—but inside Eva, everything felt shattered.